

Timothy Ott

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Professional Experience:

Academic positions:

The University of North Carolina at Chapel Hill

2018-Present

Assistant Professor of Strategy & Entrepreneurship

Education:

Stanford University, Stanford CA

April 2018

PhD in Management Science & Engineering (Stanford Technology Ventures Program)

Dissertation Title: *From Opportunity to Strategy: How executives create a system of interdependent strategic decisions*

Dissertation Committee: Kathleen Eisenhardt (Chair), Chuck Eesley, Riitta Katila

Stanford University, Stanford CA

June 2009

Master of Science in Management Science & Engineering

University of Pennsylvania, Philadelphia PA

May 2005

Jerome Fisher Program in Management and Technology

Wharton School of Business –BS in Economics, concentration in Management, Magna Cum Laude.

School of Engineering and Applied Science –BAS in Computer Science Engineering, Magna Cum Laude.

Minor from the College of Arts & Sciences in Psychology

Wharton and Engineering Dean's Lists - 2002-2005.

Interests:

Research Interests:

Strategic decision making

Entrepreneurial strategy

Organizational learning

Grand challenges

Teaching Interests:

Strategy

Entrepreneurship

Organizational behavior

Organizational theory

Methods Interests:

Theory-building case studies

Simulation

Qualitative comparative analysis

Other professional experience:

VoxPop.tv, San Francisco, CA

2009

Business and Marketing Intern

CGI, Fairfax, VA

2005–2009, 2010

Consultant

Uptdata Venture Partners, Red Bank, NJ

2003-2004

Honors:

2019-2021: SRF Research in Strategic Management Scholar (1 of 3 this year)

2024: Outstanding Reviewer Award – Strategy division, Academy of Management.

2021: Outstanding Reviewer Award – Strategy division, Academy of Management.

2020: Outstanding Reviewer Award – Strategy division, Academy of Management.
2014: SRF Dissertation Research Program – Strategic Management Society (1 of 15 this year)
2014: Outstanding Reviewer Award – Managerial & Organizational Cognition division, Academy of Management.
2013, 2014, 2015: MacKenzie Fellowship

Bibliography:

Refereed Journal Articles:

Ott, T., K. M. Eisenhardt & C. Bingham. (2017) “Strategy Formation Processes: Past Insights and Future Directions.” *Strategic Entrepreneurship Journal*, 11(3), 306-325.

Bingham, C., T. Howell & **T. Ott.** (2019) “Capability Creation: Heuristics as Microfoundations.” *Strategic Entrepreneurship Journal*, 13(2), 121-153.

Ott, T. & K.M. Eisenhardt. (2020) “Decision Weaving: Forming Novel, Complex Strategy in Entrepreneurial Settings.” *Strategic Management Journal*, 41(12), 2275-2314.

Ott, T. & D. Hannah. (2024) “On the Origin of Entrepreneurial Theories: How entrepreneurs craft complex causal models with theorizing and data.” *Strategy Science*, 9(4):461-482, <https://doi.org/10.1287/stsc.2024.0178>.

Journal Articles Submitted/Under Peer Review:

Hannah, D., A. Marquez & **T. Ott.** “Putting entrepreneurial theories into action: Evidence from a matched study of three solar ventures.” Revise and resubmit (second round) at *Strategic Management Journal*. (38 pages)

Hill, R., I. Guler & **T. Ott.** “Prison entrepreneurship training and recidivism.” Revise and resubmit (first round) at *Management Science*. (36 pages)

Ott, T & P. Ozcan. “Beyond the Chicken and Egg: How entrepreneurs prepare to jumpstart network effects to scale up platforms.” Under review (second round) at *Strategic Management Journal*. (42 pages)

Book Chapters:

Eisenhardt, K.M. & **T. Ott.** *Rigor in Theory-Building from Multiple Cases.* In Routledge Companion to Qualitative Research in Organization Studies. Edited by Raza Mir and Sanjay Jain. Routledge, New York, 2017. Pp 79-91.

Bingham, C., **T. Ott,** & K. M. Eisenhardt. *Simple Rules.* In The Palgrave Encyclopedia of Strategic Management. Vol 1. Edited by Mie Augier and David J. Teece. Palgrave Macmillan Publishers, 2013. Pp 1-4.

Research Projects in Preparation for Journal Submission:

Ott, T. & D. Hannah. “Moderate Obsession from Entrepreneurial Vision: How stronger visions of the future lead to value-based strategic decision-making in the present.” Working paper.

Ott, T., D.Hannah, & R. Tidhar. “Degree of Focus as a Tool for Effective Strategy Formation in Nascent Markets.” Working paper. (40 pages)

Ott, T., R. Hill & H. Ahn. “Entrepreneurial Advice Seeking: Seeking outside knowledge for strategy formation in entrepreneurial settings.” Data analysis.

Fairchild, A, **T. Ott** & M. Moeen. “Scaling up to Drawdown: Entrepreneurs and system architects in the nascent carbon removal industry.” Data collection.

Peer Reviewed Conference Presentations:

Moderate Obsession from Entrepreneurial Vision: How stronger visions of the future lead to value-based strategic decision-making in the present. Strategic Management Society Annual Conference, San Francisco, CA. October 2025.

Moderate Obsession from Entrepreneurial Vision: How stronger visions of the future lead to value-based strategic decision-making in the present. West Coast Research Symposium, Seattle, WA. September 2025.

Beyond the Chicken or Egg: How entrepreneurs organize learning in two-sided market ventures to jumpstart network effects. Strategy Science Conference, Barcelona, Spain. June 2025.

Foundations of a theory-based view of strategy, entrepreneurship, and innovation. The Academy of Management Annual Meeting, Boston, MA. August 2023.

Pivoting and Its Challenges: Pushing the frontiers of an emerging domain. The Academy of Management Annual Meeting, Seattle, WA. August 2022.

Not All Those Who Wander Are Lost: Cognitive inertia as a driver of strategic change. The Academy of Management Annual Meeting, Virtual. August 2021.

Exploring Strategic Rhythms in the Digital Economy, Panel. The Academy of Management Annual Meeting, Virtual. August 2021.

Strategy Formation as Solving a Complex and Novel Problem. The Academy of Management Annual Meeting, Boston, MA. August 2019.

Beyond the Chicken and Egg: Strategy Formation in Two-Sided Marketplace Ventures. Strategic Management Society Annual Conference, Paris, France. September 2018.

Entrepreneurial Advice Seeking. Strategic Management Society Annual Conference, Paris, France. September 2018.

Decision Weaving: The Microfoundations of Strategy Formation in Entrepreneurial Settings. The Academy of Management Annual Meeting, Chicago, IL. August 2018.

Decision Weaving: The Microfoundations of Strategy Formation in Entrepreneurial Settings. Strategy Science Conference, Philadelphia, PA. June 2018.

Building communities: Strategically leveraging direct network effects to build multi-sided platforms. Sharing Strategies for the Connected World, SMS Special Conference, Oslo, Norway. June 2018.

Decision Weaving: Effective Strategy Formation in Entrepreneurial Settings. Wharton Technology & Innovation Conference, Philadelphia, PA. April 2018.

Weaving Strategic Decisions Together: Strategy Formation under Novelty, Resource Constraint, and Complexity. Strategic Management Society Annual Conference, Berlin, Germany. September 2016.

Envisioning Limitations: How vision restrains strategic decision making. The Academy of Management Annual Meeting, Anaheim, CA. August 2016.

The use of analogy by top-management teams. The Summer Institute on Bounded Rationality 2013: Decision Making in a Social World. Max Planck Institute for Human Development, Berlin, Germany. June 2013.

Other Presentations:

Invited Presentations

- *Beyond the Chicken or Egg: How entrepreneurs organize learning in two-sided market ventures to jumpstart network effects.* Colorado State University, Fort Collins, CO. December 2025.
- *Not All Those Who Wander Are Lost: Cognitive inertia as a driver of strategic change.* NC State Poole College of Business, Raleigh, NC. November 2024.
- *Talking with entrepreneurs about grand challenges.* STR Virtual Symposium: How to generate impactful data, Virtual. June 2024.
- *Not all those who wander are lost: The dynamics of novelty and inertia in theory-driven online experimentation.* Wharton Management Department seminar, Philadelphia, PA. January 2023.
- *Strategy formation processes: The interplay between “thinking” and “doing”.* SMS Extension: Decision Making in Strategy, Entrepreneurship, and Innovation, London, UK. September 2022.
- *Platform emergence.* Emergence: Organizations, Markets, Platforms, and Regions Conference, Chapel Hill, NC. August 2021.
- *Not All Those Who Wander Are Lost: Founding Motivation, Lay Theory, and the Origin of Ecosystem Strategy.* Smith Entrepreneurship Research Conference, College Park, MD. April 2019.
- *Strategy Formation as Solving a Complex and Novel Problem.* Austin Technology & Entrepreneurship Conference, Austin, TX, February 2019.
- *Cutting Edge of Ecosystem Strategy.* SMS extension at INSEAD, Fontainebleau, France. September 2018.
- *Managerial Cognitive Capabilities.* Dartmouth Junior Faculty Summer Camp, Hanover, NH. August 2018.
- *Tackling a Single Topic with Multiple Methods.* Research Methods Division-CARMA Doctoral Student and Junior Faculty Consortium, Virtual. June 2018.
- *Decision Weaving: Effective Strategy Formation in Entrepreneurial Settings.* Smith Entrepreneurship Research Conference, College Park, MD. April 2018.
- *Job Market Presentations:* Boston University, IESE Business School, Imperial College London, Harvard Business School, UNC-Chapel Hill, University College London.
- *Interdependence in Strategic Decision Making.* Strategic Management Society Annual Conference, Berlin, Germany. September 2016.

Teaching Experience:

2025	MBA	MBA 800 (Strategic Management)	206 students
2024	MBA	MBA 800 (Strategic Management)	251 students
2024	PhD	Busi 899 (Qualitative Research Methods)	5 students
2023	MBA	MBA 800 (Strategic Management)	248 students
2022	MBA	MBA 800 (Strategic Management)	240 students
2022	PhD	Busi 899 (Qualitative Research Methods)	4 students
2022 (two mods)	Undergrad	Busi 411 (Business Strategy)	193 students
2021	PhD	Busi 899 (Qualitative Research Methods)	7 students
2021 (online & in-person)	Undergrad	Busi 411 (Business Strategy)	102 students
2020	Undergrad	Busi 411 (Business Strategy)	115 students
2019	PhD	Busi 899 (Qualitative Research Methods)	8 students

2019	Undergrad	Busi 411 (Business Strategy)	119 students
2018	Undergrad	Busi 411 (Business Strategy)	117 students

Student Mentorship:

Dissertation Committee Member, Yeojin Kim, May 2026

How founders leverage employees' knowledge as they hire employees

Dissertation Committee Member, Angie Fairchild, May 2024

Corporate Decarbonization & Climate Change Mitigation

Dissertation Committee Member, Jenny Hill, May 2024

Observing the Overlooked: Three Essays on Mainstreet, Prisoner, and Immigrant Entrepreneurs

Honors Thesis Reader, Colleen Brown, April 2024

Money, Money, Money: An Exploration of the Impact of Rising Ticket Prices on Consumer Perceptions

Dissertation Committee Member, Christopher Law, August 2023

Building Culture in Entrepreneurial Firms

Dissertation Committee Member, Robert Hill, May 2022

Three Essays on Entrepreneurial Prison Training

Dissertation Committee Member, Youthika Chauhan, May 2021

Essays on Social Entrepreneurship in Low- / Middle-Income Countries

Honors Thesis Advisor, Cameron Keating, April 2021

The Psychology of Entrepreneurial Resilience: How Tech Entrepreneurs Responded to a Year of Crisis

Dissertation Committee Member, Travis Howell, May 2020

Surrounding the Founder: Examining the Hidden Figures in Entrepreneurship

Academic Service

To Discipline

- Editorial review board member, Strategic Entrepreneurship Journal, 2023-present
- Representative at large, Entrepreneurship & Strategy IG, Strategic Management Society, 2022-2024
- Research committee member, Technology & Innovation Management division, Academy of Management, 2022-2024

Reviewer

- Strategic Management Journal, 2016-present
- Strategic Entrepreneurship Journal, 2018-present
- Organization Science, 2019-present
- Academy of Management Journal, 2019-present
- Strategy Science, 2024-present
- Administrative Science Quarterly, 2025-present
- Reviewer for SMS PhD paper prize, 2025
- Reviewer for INFORMS/Organization Science Dissertation Proposal Competition, 2020-present
- Reviewer for SMS SRF Dissertation Research Grant, 2021 – present
- Reviewer for TIM Best Paper Award, 2021 - present
- Reviewer for SMS, 2018-present
- Reviewer for the Strategic Management, Academy of Management, 2014-present
- Reviewer for SMS special conference Hangzhou, 2020
- Reviewer for the Managerial & Organizational Cognition, Academy of Management, 2013-2019
- Reviewer for SMS special conference Frankfurt, 2018

Conference Service

- Session chair for Entrepreneurship and Strategy Track, SMS Annual Conference, San Francisco, 2025
- Discussant at Austin Technology and Entrepreneurship Conference, Austin, 2025
- Discussant for “Minds at Work PDW”, AOM Annual Conference, Chicago, 2024
- Organizer and discussant for “Studying emerging technologies PDW”, SMS Annual Conference, Toronto, 2023
- Organizer and discussant for “Junior Faculty PDW”, SMS Annual Conference, Toronto, 2023
- Organizer and moderator for “Entrepreneurship for the social good” panel, SMS Annual Conference, London, 2002
- Session chair for Entrepreneurship and Strategy Track, SMS Annual Conference, Toronto, 2021
- Panelist SMS Media Innovations Virtual Reception: Generating Impact in the Digital Sphere, SMS Annual conference, Virtual, 2020.
- Session chair for Entrepreneurship and Strategy Track, SMS Annual Conference, Berlin, 2016
- Program coordinator for West Coast Research Symposium, 2013
- Session chair for TIM division, Academy of Management Annual Meeting, 2012

Within UNC – Chapel Hill

- Deloitte Case Competition Judge, 2023-present
- Undergraduate Business Program Core Curriculum Committee, 2020-2023
- Guest Speaker for Spark orientation’s technology careers track, 2020
- Faculty Advisor for Spark Undergraduate Business Program Cohort, 2019-2020

Professional Associations

INFORMS 2018-present

Strategic Management Society 2014-present

Academy of Management 2012-present

Last Updated: 07/06/2026